

Lord, I want to be a Christian

Text: African-American spiritual,
Folk Songs of the American Negro, 1907
LORD, I WANT TO BE irregular

Music: African-American spiritual,
Folk Songs of the American Negro, 1907

The musical score is written for a single voice in treble clef, with a key signature of three sharps (F#, C#, G#) and a 4/4 time signature. The melody is simple and repetitive, consisting of eighth and quarter notes. The lyrics are arranged in four stanzas, each corresponding to a line of music. The first stanza includes a numbered list of four variations. The second and fourth stanzas end with a double bar line. The third stanza features a long note with a slur over it, indicating a sustained sound.

1 Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart, in my heart.
2 Lord, I want to be more lov - ing...
3 Lord, I want to be more ho - ly...
4 Lord, I want to be like Je - sus...
Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart.
In my heart, in my heart,
Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart.